Chicago Crime & Schools Executive Dashboard

Analytical Summary Report

Dashboard Overview — The Complete Picture

The executive dashboard consolidates crime, poverty, and school performance data into one unified view across Chicago's 77 communities.

It highlights where crime is improving, where it is rising, and how socioeconomic conditions influence outcomes.

Key Takeaways

1. Overall Crime Is Declining — But Emerging Threats Are Rising

- Total crime decreased by 5.8% over five years
- Concealed carry violations increased by 669%
- Stalking increased by 221%

While overall crime is falling, specific categories are escalating rapidly. This indicates a need for targeted interventions rather than broad enforcement strategies.

---

2. Fourteen Communities Require Immediate Attention

High-risk communities such as Humboldt Park, Austin, and North Lawndale experience the highest combined levels of crime and poverty.

The poverty vs crime scatter plot clearly shows a strong positive relationship: Higher poverty generally corresponds with higher crime.

Encouragingly, there are zero "critical-risk" communities — suggesting the worst-case scenarios are being avoided.

---

3. Schools in High-Crime Areas Face Major Disparities

In high-crime neighborhoods:

- Safety scores are 21.7 points lower
- Math proficiency is 11.8 points lower

Children in these communities face both neighborhood safety challenges and academic disadvantages.

This gap reinforces the link between public safety and educational equity.

---

4. Crime Types Vary by Community Wealth

- Homicide, narcotics, and gambling are heavily concentrated in poor neighborhoods
- Theft and deceptive practices are more common in wealthier areas

Resource allocation should reflect these differences rather than applying uniform strategies citywide.

What This Means

The data confirms that crime and poverty are deeply interconnected.

Reducing crime requires addressing both:

- Public safety
- Economic hardship

The dashboard provides a clear roadmap:

- Prioritize the 14 high-risk communities
- Target rising crimes like illegal gun violations
- Close the school safety and academic performance gap

Effective policy must combine enforcement, prevention, and socioeconomic investment.